Mathematics – Number – Belonging Curriculum

The Belonging Curriculum provides the foundation for all later mathematical learning. At this stage, pupils are not yet learning discrete mathematical concepts such as counting, cardinality or shape. Instead, they are developing the essential behaviours, awareness and experiences that enable mathematical understanding to emerge over time.

Through exploration, play, routines and meaningful interactions, pupils learn to notice changes, anticipate events, recognise patterns, respond to differences, explore space and engage with quantities and objects. These early mathematical behaviours form the building blocks for future learning across number, shape, space and measure.

The curriculum is organised into three developmental learning areas which reflect the gradual progression from awareness, to participation, to the recognition of early mathematical relationships. Although pupils may demonstrate learning across multiple areas simultaneously, the framework provides a guide to the typical progression of mathematical development within the Belonging Curriculum.

Pathway aim

By the end of the Belonging Curriculum, pupils will engage with and respond to mathematical experiences in their everyday lives, developing awareness of objects, quantities, patterns, space, position and change. Through exploration, interaction and routines, pupils will use these skills to make sense of their environment, participate in daily activities and increase their independence and understanding of the world around them.

Learning Area 1: Awareness, Attention & Anticipation **(Broadly Band 1)** Pupils develop awareness of mathematical experiences through attention, curiosity and anticipation of familiar people, objects, actions and routines.	**Learning Area 2: Participation, Exploration & Response** **(Broadly Band 2)** Pupils become active participants in mathematical experiences, exploring, responding and interacting with objects, patterns, quantities and spaces.	**Learning Area 3: Recognition, Matching & Early Relationships** **(Broadly Band 3)** Pupils begin to recognise, match and connect objects, actions and quantities, laying the foundations for later mathematical understanding.

Key Stage Target By the end of the key stage, the pupil will demonstrate awareness of people, objects, actions and changes within mathematical experiences.	**Key Stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will actively explore mathematical experiences and respond to differences, patterns and quantities.	**Key Stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will recognise simple relationships between objects, quantities and actions and begin to apply these during play and exploration.
Typical targets might include • I can attend to counting songs, rhymes and routines • I can react to changes in amount when they are significant • I can notice when something has been added or taken away • I can demonstrate awareness of more through looking, reaching or vocalising • I can show interest in patterned songs and rhymes • I can begin to predict what happens next in predictable situations • I can respond to very big or very small items	**Typical targets might include** • I can respond to words like more • I can anticipate when more items are added • I can respond differently to one object and many objects • I can join in with familiar counting routines • I can explore space around me and engage with position and direction • I can stack objects using flat surfaces • I can join in with repeated patterns in songs and stories • I can explore different sizes in play • I can empty containers • I can show awareness of routines	**Typical targets might include** • I can notice when a group becomes bigger or smaller • I can combine small groups and notice there are more • I can follow objects or sounds as they are counted or moved • I can link number words to objects • I can use number words such as one or two when pointing to objects • I can begin to match one object to another • I can move objects into and out of spaces • I can begin to select a shape for a specific space • I can recognise patterns in my daily routines • I can begin to arrange items in my own patterns • I can explore size and weight • I can begin to understand now and later
Next Step Develop active participation in mathematical experiences and routines.	**Next Step** Begin to recognise relationships between objects, quantities and actions.	**Next Step** Develop specific mathematical concepts through the Achievement curriculum: